

Elastic/Kibana Incident Investigation

Scenario: You are a SOC analyst reviewing Elastic telemetry from a Windows endpoint. The host generated several alerts after a Microsoft Office document was opened. You are not initially told the malware family. Your job is to reconstruct the intrusion from evidence, identify persistence, find the C2 mechanism, and prepare a concise incident report.

Recommended index names (Optional): Use the following names so the lab queries are consistent. If you already used different names, adjust the `_index` filter in each query.

Upload file	Index name
ep7data.ndjson	logs-ommep7events
ep7alerts.ndjson	logs-ommep7alerts

Upload steps

- Download ep7data.ndjson.gz and decompress it to ep7data.ndjson.
- In Kibana, go to Home -> Upload a file.
- Upload ep7data.ndjson and click Import.
- Open the Advanced tab.
- Set the index name to logs-ommep7events.
- Add this index setting: "mapping.total_fields.limit":"6000".
- Replace the generated mapping with the contents of mapping.json.
- Click Import.

Repeat the same process for ep7alerts.ndjson using index name logs-ommep7alerts and the same mapping.json.

Create the data view

Data view name: Data View – ep7

Index pattern: logs-ommep7*

Timestamp field: @timestamp

Time picker: Set Kibana time to Last 10 years first. After confirming data exists, narrow to the known activity window: 2023-04-01 22:00:00 UTC -> 2023-04-01 22:15:00 UTC

1) Questions: Analyze alerts

- Which alert gives the first reliable investigation lead?
- Which application appears to be the parent process?
- Which child process is launched?
- What script path is used?

2) Identify the malicious document and suspicious child process

Question: What document started the suspicious process chain?

3) Pivot into raw events for the Word-to-script chain

Question: Can we prove the alert with raw endpoint events?

4) Find dropped script files

Question:

- What files were dropped to disk?
- Why is C:\ProgramData a suspicious staging location?

5) Investigate scheduled-task persistence

Question:

- Did the malware create a persistence mechanism?
- Which part of the command shows persistence frequency?

6) Follow PowerShell execution

Question: How does the VBScript launch the main payload?

7) Investigate BONDUPDATER working files and folders

Question: What local artifacts does the payload create for state, staging, and data transfer?

8) Identify DNS-based command and control

Question: Did the payload communicate over DNS?

9) **Evidence table:** Complete the following evidence table:

Evidence type	Expected evidence
Initial file	
Parent process	
Script host	
Dropped scripts	
Persistence command	
PowerShell payload	
Working artifacts	
C2 domain	